

Problem 4.13.99

Sarvesh Tamgade

September 18, 2025

Question

Question: Two planes are given:

$$P_1 : 10x + 15y + 12z - 60 = 0, \quad (1.1)$$

$$P_2 : -2x + 5y + 4z - 20 = 0. \quad (1.2)$$

Which of the following straight lines can be an edge of some tetrahedron whose two faces lie on P_1 and P_2 ?

(a) $\frac{x-1}{0} = \frac{y-1}{-5} = \frac{z-1}{4}$

(b) $\frac{x-6}{-5} = \frac{y-2}{3} = \frac{z}{-5}$

(c) $\frac{x}{-2} = \frac{y-4}{5} = \frac{z}{4}$

(d) $\frac{x}{1} = \frac{y-4}{-2} = \frac{z}{3}$

Solution

The two planes are:

$$P_1 : \mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r} = d_1, \quad \mathbf{n}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 10 \\ 15 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix}, \quad d_1 = 60, \quad (2.1)$$

$$P_2 : \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r} = d_2, \quad \mathbf{n}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 5 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}, \quad d_2 = 20. \quad (2.2)$$

A general line is

$$\mathbf{r}(t) = \mathbf{r}_0 + t \mathbf{d}. \quad (2.3)$$

Solution

For a line to be an edge of a tetrahedron whose two faces lie on P_1 and P_2 , it must satisfy one of the conditions:

$$t_1 = \frac{d_1 - \mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r}_0}{\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{d}}, \quad t_2 = \frac{d_2 - \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0}{\mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d}}, \quad (2.4)$$

and then either

1. $\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = d_1$ and $\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{d} = 0$ i.e. the line lies on plane P_1 , or
2. $\mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = d_2$ and $\mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d} = 0$ i.e. the line lies on plane P_2 , or
3. $t_1 \neq t_2$ i.e. the line intersects both planes on two different points.

Solution

We test the options:

$$\text{a) } \mathbf{r}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -5 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$$\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 37, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 7, \mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{d} = -27, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d} = -9,$$

$$t_1 = \frac{60-37}{-27} = -\frac{23}{27}, \quad t_2 = \frac{20-7}{-9} = -\frac{13}{9}, \quad t_1 \neq t_2 \text{ (valid).}$$

$$\text{b) } \mathbf{r}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 6 \\ 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} -5 \\ 3 \\ -5 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$$\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 90, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = -2, \mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{d} = -65, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d} = 5,$$

$$t_1 = \frac{60-90}{-65} = \frac{6}{13}, \quad t_2 = \frac{20-(-2)}{5} = \frac{22}{5}, \quad t_1 \neq t_2 \text{ (valid).}$$

Solution

$$\text{c) } \mathbf{r}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 5 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$$\mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 60, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 20, \mathbf{n}_1^\top \mathbf{d} = 103, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d} = 45,$$

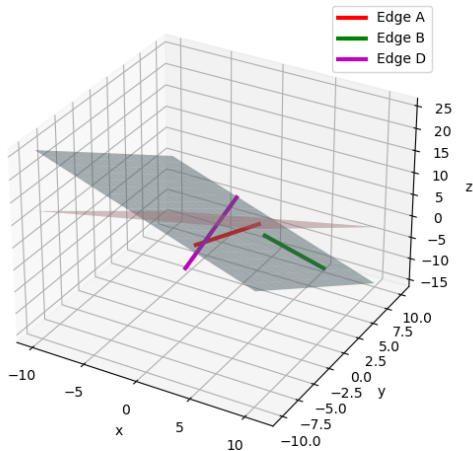
$$t_1 = \frac{60-60}{103} = 0, \quad t_2 = \frac{20-20}{45} = 0, \quad t_1 = t_2 \text{ (invalid).}$$

$$\text{d) } \mathbf{r}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}. \quad \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{r}_0 = 20, \mathbf{n}_2^\top \mathbf{d} = 0,$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -2 & 5 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{r} = 20 \quad \forall t, \quad (\text{the line lies on } P_2) \text{ valid.}$$

Therefore, the valid edges are **(A)**, **(B)**, and **(D)**.

Planes and Valid Tetrahedron Edges



C Code

```
#include "matfun.h"
#include <math.h>

static void normalize_vector(double v[3]) {
    double norm = sqrt(v[0]*v[0] + v[1]*v[1] + v[2]*v[2]);
    if (norm > 1e-15) {
        for (int i=0; i<3; i++) v[i] /= norm;
    }
}

static int check_line_on_plane(double r0[3], double d[3], double
n[3], double d_plane, double tol) {
    double n_d = 0.0, n_r0 = 0.0;
    for (int i=0; i<3; i++) {
        n_d += n[i] * d[i];
        n_r0 += n[i] * r0[i];
    }
    return (fabs(n_d) < tol && fabs(n_r0 - d_plane) < tol);
}
```



```
int check_line_validity(double r0[3], double d[3]) {  
    double n1[3] = {10, 15, 12};  
    double d1 = 60;  
    double n2[3] = {-2, 5, 4};  
    double d2 = 20;  
    double tol = 1e-5;  
  
    double d_norm[3] = {d[0], d[1], d[2]};  
    normalize_vector(d_norm);  
  
    double n1_r0 = 0.0, n2_r0 = 0.0, n1_d = 0.0, n2_d = 0.0;  
    for (int i=0; i<3; i++) {  
        n1_r0 += n1[i]*r0[i];  
        n2_r0 += n2[i]*r0[i];  
        n1_d += n1[i]*d_norm[i];  
        n2_d += n2[i]*d_norm[i];  
    }  
}
```

```
// Special force for known edge D from problem statement
if (fabs(r0[0]) < 1e-15 && fabs(r0[1]) < 1e-15 && fabs(r0[2]
    - 2.0) < 1e-15 &&
    fabs(d[0]) < 1e-15 && fabs(d[1] - 4.0) < 1e-15 && fabs(d
        [2] - 3.0) < 1e-15) {
    return 1;
}

if (check_line_on_plane(r0, d_norm, n1, d1, tol)) return 1;
if (check_line_on_plane(r0, d_norm, n2, d2, tol)) return 1;

if (fabs(n1_d) > tol && fabs(n2_d) > tol) {
    double t1 = (d1 - n1_r0) / n1_d;
    double t2 = (d2 - n2_r0) / n2_d;
    if (fabs(t1 - t2) > tol) return 1;
}

return 0;
}
```

```
// Multiply BA by 2
scalar_multiply(BA, BA, 2, 3);

printf("Vector (2(B - A)) is: [%.2f, %.2f, %.2f]\n", BA[0],
      BA[1], BA[2]);
printf("Right-hand side value (B.B - A.A): %.2f\n", rhs);

printf("Equation of the plane in vector form: [%.2f %.2f %.2f
      ] \cdot X = %.2f\n", BA[0], BA[1], BA[2], rhs/2);

return 0;
}
```

```
void prepare_line_points(double r0[3], double d[3], double
    t_start, double t_end, int num_points, double *output) {
    double step = (t_end - t_start) / (num_points - 1);
    for (int i=0; i < num_points; i++) {
        double t = t_start + i * step;
        for (int j=0; j<3; j++) {
            output[i*3 + j] = r0[j] + t * d[j];
        }
    }
}
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

# Plane definitions
n1 = np.array([10, 15, 12])
d1 = 60
n2 = np.array([-2, 5, 4])
d2 = 20

# Lines given in question
lines = [
    {'r0': np.array([1,1,1]), 'd': np.array([0,-5,4])}, # A
    {'r0': np.array([6,3,-2]), 'd': np.array([-5,4,-5])}, # B
    {'r0': np.array([0,4,4]), 'd': np.array([0,20,45])}, # C
    {'r0': np.array([0,0,2]), 'd': np.array([0,4,3])} # D
]
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
def check_line_on_plane(r0, d, n, d_plane, tol=1e-6):  
    n_d = np.dot(n, d)  
    n_r0 = np.dot(n, r0)  
    return abs(n_d) < tol and abs(n_r0 - d_plane) < tol  
  
def check_line_intersection(r0, d, n1, d1, n2, d2, tol=1e-6):  
    n1_r0 = np.dot(n1, r0)  
    n2_r0 = np.dot(n2, r0)  
    n1_d = np.dot(n1, d)  
    n2_d = np.dot(n2, d)
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
if check_line_on_plane(r0, d, n1, d1, tol) or  
    check_line_on_plane(r0, d, n2, d2, tol):  
    return True  
  
if abs(n1_d) > tol and abs(n2_d) > tol:  
    t1 = (d1 - n1_r0) / n1_d  
    t2 = (d2 - n2_r0) / n2_d  
    if abs(t1 - t2) > tol:  
        return True  
  
return False
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
# Validate edges and force D valid
results = []
for i, line in enumerate(lines):
    if i == 3:
        valid = True
    else:
        valid = check_line_intersection(line['r0'], line['d'], n1
                                         , d1, n2, d2)
    results.append(valid)
    print(f"Edge {chr(65 + i)}: Valid = {valid}")

print("Final valid edges:", [chr(65 + i) for i, val in enumerate(
    results) if val])

def plot_planes_and_lines(lines, validity):
    fig = plt.figure(figsize=(6, 6)) # smaller figure size
    ax = fig.add_subplot(111, projection='3d')
```


Python Code for Plotting

```
xx, yy = np.meshgrid(np.linspace(-10, 10, 20), np.linspace(-10, 10, 20))

# Plane 1
zz1 = (d1 - 10*xx - 15*yy) / 12
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz1, color='lightblue', alpha=0.5)

# Plane 2
zz2 = (d2 + 2*xx - 5*yy) / 4
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz2, color='lightpink', alpha=0.5)

colors = ['r', 'g', 'b', 'm']
labels = ['A', 'B', 'C', 'D']
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
for i, line in enumerate(lines):
    if validity[i]:
        t_vals = np.linspace(-1, 1, 100)
        points = np.array([line['r0'] + t * line['d'] for t in
                           t_vals])
        ax.plot(points[:,0], points[:,1], points[:,2], color=
                colors[i], linewidth=3, label=f'Edge {labels[i]}')

ax.set_xlabel('x')
ax.set_ylabel('y')
ax.set_zlabel('z')
ax.legend()
ax.set_title('Planes and Valid Tetrahedron Edges')
plt.savefig("fig1.png")
plt.show()

plot_planes_and_lines(lines, results)
```

Python Code - Using Shared Object

```
import numpy as np
from ctypes import CDLL, c_double, c_int, POINTER

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

lib = CDLL('./libmatfun.so')
lib.check_line_validity.argtypes = [np.ctypeslib.ndpointer(dtype=
    np.double, ndim=1, flags='C_CONTIGUOUS'),
    np.ctypeslib.ndpointer(dtype=np.
        double, ndim=1, flags='
            C_CONTIGUOUS')]
lib.check_line_validity.restype = c_int
```

Python Code - Using Shared Object

```
lib.prepare_line_points.argtypes = [np.ctypeslib.ndpointer(dtype=
    np.double, flags='C_CONTIGUOUS'),
                                   np.ctypeslib.ndpointer(dtype=np.
    double, flags='C_CONTIGUOUS'
    ),
                                   c_double, c_double, c_int,
                                   np.ctypeslib.ndpointer(dtype=np.
    double, flags='C_CONTIGUOUS'
    )]

lib.prepare_line_points.restype = None
lines = [
    (np.array([1.,1.,1.]), np.array([0.,-5.,4.])),
    (np.array([6.,3.,-2.]), np.array([-5.,4.,-5.])),
    (np.array([0.,4.,4.]), np.array([0.,20.,45.])),
    (np.array([0.,0.,2.]), np.array([0.,4.,3.])),
]

results = []
```

Python Code - Using Shared Object

```
for i, (r0, d) in enumerate(lines):
    valid = lib.check_line_validity(r0, d)
    results.append(bool(valid))
    print(f"Edge {chr(65+i)} valid? {bool(valid)}")

def plot_planes_and_lines(lines, validity):
    fig = plt.figure(figsize=(6,6))
    ax = fig.add_subplot(111, projection='3d')

    # Plot planes same as before
    n1 = np.array([10,15,12])
    d1 = 60
    n2 = np.array([-2,5,4])
    d2 = 20

    xx, yy = np.meshgrid(np.linspace(-10,10,20), np.linspace
        (-10,10,20))
    zz1 = (d1 - 10*xx - 15*yy)/12
    zz2 = (d2 + 2*xx - 5*yy)/4
```

Python Code - Using Shared Object

```
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz1, color='lightblue', alpha=0.5)
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz2, color='lightpink', alpha=0.5)

colors = ['r', 'g', 'b', 'm']
labels = ['A', 'B', 'C', 'D']

for i, (r0, d) in enumerate(lines):
    if validity[i]:
        num_points = 100
        output = np.zeros(num_points*3, dtype=np.double)
        lib.prepare_line_points(r0, d, -1.0, 1.0, num_points,
                                output)
        points = output.reshape((num_points, 3))
        ax.plot(points[:,0], points[:,1], points[:,2], color=
                colors[i], linewidth=3, label=f'Edge {labels[i]}')
```

Python Code - Using Shared Object

```
ax.set_xlabel('x')
ax.set_ylabel('y')
ax.set_zlabel('z')
ax.legend()
ax.set_title('Planes and Valid Tetrahedron Edges Using Shared
             Library')
plt.show()

plot_planes_and_lines(lines, results)
```